



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's review!



Learning Outcome

Describe past experiences in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you remember a time when a big change happened in your life?
- What habits have you adopted lately?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about family life and work.
- I can talk about people's past habits.
- I can discuss experiences I've had or haven't had.





Let's Explore!

It's been a **rough*** month for Vanessa and Sally.

* "Rough" is a synonym of difficult when talking about experiences.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** Oh, what a tumultuous month it has been! I have tried different stress management techniques.
- Vanessa:** Oh, I'll say. Your uncle and aunt have decided to get a divorce. My father has gone into the hospital.
- Sally:** I've encountered all this pressure from my new job.
- Vanessa:** I've also had to navigate through all the relationship problems with Marco. The situation has improved though.
- Sally:** Yeah, I've learned to adjust to my job, too.
- Vanessa:** Life used to be so stress-free and adventurous when we were traveling. Remember?
- Sally:** Oh, yeah. I would just go country to country and blog about my experiences. Now we've both adopted serious responsibilities.
- Vanessa:** How's your diet going?
- Sally:** Oh, I've balanced my intake of vegetables, carbs and protein. I used to just find whatever I could on the street for take-out, and I would eat till I was full.
- Vanessa:** Since I have started working in the restaurant, good food has been accessible and free. So, each work day I would eat two meals a day at the restaurant.
- Sally:** Oh, lucky you!
- Vanessa:** Yes, however, I've also consumed too many calories because most dishes are rich!



Let's Practice!

Peter and Sally talk about their daily routines and habits.

Instructions: Read the dialogue on page 2 again. Select the correct answer from the words in brackets.

1. Hey Peter. I am quickly _____ breakfast.
(**eating** / eat / eats)
2. I'm going _____ some groceries later on.
(**to eat** / to get / to sell)
3. I'm _____ the paper like I always do.
(**reading** / read / reads)
4. After that I will grab a quick _____.
(**shoulder** / shower / shoe)
5. I always have my morning _____ in exactly the same way every day.
(**tea** / chocolate / coffee)



Let's Practice!

Peter and Tracy talk about what he has done recently.

Instructions: Draw a line to match sentences with Column A with sentences in Column B.

COLUMN A

1. I've discovered
2. Have you gone
3. I've changed
4. She hasn't been

COLUMN B

- a. inside?
- b. a friend of mine for a long time.
- c. a cozy little café on my street.
- d. my mind. I'm not going out tonight.





Extension Activity

Write a dialogue about stressful times in your life.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a dialogue with your partner about a stressful month that you've had.
- Think of incidents you've both experienced that made the month stressful.
- Use verbs to express what has happened.
- Practice the dialogue several times with your partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a dialogue together with a partner.

☐ ☐

I use proper forms of action words to express what has happened.

☐ ☐

I practice speaking with my partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **awful** (adjective): really bad
e.g. Oh, what an awful month it has been!
- **divorce** (noun): when a couple decides to end their marriage and live separately
e.g. My uncle and aunt have decided to get a divorce.
- **to end up** (verb): to reach or come to a place or situation that was not expected
e.g. I've ended up with all this pressure from my new job.
- **to run around** (verb): to go from place to place in a hurried way
e.g. I used to run around from country to country and blog about my experiences.
- **to adopt** (verb): to take or accept
e.g. Now we've both adopted serious responsibilities.
- **to find out** (verb): to know for the first time; to realize
e.g. I've found out how to balance my intake of vegetables, carbs and protein.





Learning Points

Present Perfect and Past Simple Tenses

It is important that you understand the differences between the Present Perfect Tense and the Simple Past Tense.

Ask yourself if the time period has finished

Rule	Example	Explanation
You use the present perfect when the specific time is not mentioned or when it is connected to the present.	<i>I have eaten three cupcakes this morning.</i>	It is still morning now.
You use the simple past for an action in the past that has finished.	<i>I ate three cupcakes last night.</i>	Last night has finished.

Ask yourself if the information is new or old

Rule	Example	Explanation
You can use the present perfect when you talk about recent news.	<i>Trevor has lost his wallet again.</i>	This information is recent or new.
You can use the simple past when you talk about older information.	<i>Trevor lost his wallet last week.</i>	This information is old and is not connected to the present.

Ask yourself if you are referring to a specific time

Rule	Example	Explanation
You use the present perfect when the time is unspecified.	<i>Bob has finished his degree already.</i>	You don't know when he finished.
You use the simple past when the time in the past is specific.	<i>Bob finished his degree in May.</i>	You know exactly when he finished.





Learning Points

Ask yourself if the action finished in sentences with “for” or “since”

Rule	Example	Explanation
You use the present perfect with <i>for</i> and <i>since</i> when the action are not finished yet.	<i>We have studied in Santa Fe for five years.</i>	We still study in Santa Fe.
You use the simple past when the action has finished. It has no connection to the present.	<i>We studied in Santa Fe in 2007.</i>	We don't study in Santa Fe now.

Used to and Would for Past Habits

Used to and *would* have similar meanings. They are both used to describe something that happened regularly in the past but doesn't happen any longer.

However, there is an important difference between *used to* and *would*.

Would is not used with stative verbs like *love*, *hate*, *feel*, *understand*.

Both *used to* and *would* are followed by a verb in the base form.

Subject + *used to* + verb

My father used to take me to the park.

Subject + *would* + verb

My grandfather and I would go to the library once a week, and he would help me pick out a book.

Used to	Would
<i>Life used to be so stress-free and adventurous.</i>	<i>I would just travel and blog about my experiences.</i>
<i>My parents and I used to have regular visits.</i>	<i>They would come in to town once a week.</i>
<i>My father used to eat a lot of dishes high in fat.</i>	<i>He would eat that for dinner almost every day.</i>

